

DRS Bot

The Complete Playbook

Understand it. Set it up right. Generate a real DRS campaign.

A complete guide for first-time users

What a Deposit Return System is · What every Setup field means
Greenfield vs Brownfield · The implementation models · Every stage explained
Working with Binny · Project Knowledge · A full worked walkthrough

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1 • Welcome

This bot is an AI marketing team for Deposit Return Systems (DRS). You give it a market and an objective; it researches that market, writes a campaign strategy, builds a detailed plan and calendar, and assigns the work to your team — with you approving at every step.

It was built for Recykal and its technology arm Retearn to plan and launch DRS programmes in any geography. You do not need to be a DRS expert to use it — that is exactly what this playbook is for. By the end you will understand the domain and how to drive the tool.

What it produces

From a single Setup brief, the bot generates a connected chain of deliverables:

- Market Research — real, grounded data on the geography, demand, stakeholders, competitors and risks.
- A Campaign Charter — the strategic contract: the situation, the challenge, the objectives, the audience and the ask.
- A full campaign plan — market-entry strategy, marketing funnel, key moments, and a dense campaign + content calendar.
- Task assignments — every planned task matched to a team member by skill, exportable to a spreadsheet.

2 • Core concepts (read this first)

A few terms appear everywhere in the bot. Understanding them makes every screen obvious.

Deposit Return System (DRS)

A DRS is a scheme where a small refundable deposit is added to the price of a drink container (a plastic bottle, a can, a glass bottle). When the consumer returns the empty container, they get the deposit back. The goal is simple: dramatically increase how many containers come back for recycling instead of ending up as litter or landfill.

Greenfield vs Brownfield — the single most important choice

On the Setup screen you choose whether the project is Greenfield or Brownfield. This one choice reshapes every downstream stage — the research questions, the strategy, the messaging and the plan — so it is worth understanding deeply.

	Greenfield (New Setup)	Brownfield (Expansion)
What it means	You are entering a market with no existing DRS. Nothing is in place — the whole system must be stood up from scratch.	A DRS (or its groundwork) already exists in the market. You are entering, expanding, or building on top of it.
The core challenge	Market creation: awareness, trust, infrastructure, regulation, habit-forming from zero.	Market share and optimisation: differentiation, integration, and doing it better than what exists.
What the bot emphasises	Standing up regulation, deposits, collection points and RVMs; educating a public that has never used a DRS.	Competitive positioning, gaps in the current system, faster/cheaper/better angles, and slotting into existing rails.
Typical example	A state or country launching its very first DRS pilot.	A new operator entering a country where a DRS already runs (e.g. selling RVMs where a scheme is already live).

The three implementation models

Setup also asks how you intend to operate. Each model points the bot at a completely different kind of plan.

Model	What it means	Who it's for
End-to-End DRS (Scheme Operator)	You run the whole system: registration, deposits, collection, logistics, refunds, reporting.	An organisation taking full operational ownership of a DRS in a market.
RVM-only Provider to Retail	You supply the machines (RVMs) to retailers, rather than operating the whole scheme.	A hardware/solutions vendor (e.g. Retearn selling RVMs to a retail chain).
Tech Solutions	You provide the software backbone — registries, IoT device APIs, merchant scanner apps, escrow/clearing, consumer wallet flows and traceability.	A SaaS/platform play; no trucks or warehouses — digital rails and data.

The bot genuinely adapts to this: choose **Tech Solutions** and it plans SaaS onboarding, APIs, escrow clearances and wallet flows instead of trucks and RVM logistics. Choose **RVM-only** and it will not propose activities that model cannot deliver.

Materials

You select which container types the programme covers: **Liquor, PET (plastic bottles), Cans, MLP (multi-layer plastic)**. This is a hard boundary — the bot will reason only about the materials you select and will not cost or plan for anything outside that list. Choose exactly what your scheme actually handles.

3 • How the bot thinks — the flow and its gates

The bot works in a fixed, gated sequence. Each stage feeds the next, and you must complete them in order. This is deliberate: a plan is only as good as the research under it, so the bot will not let you build a strategy on nothing.



The gates: a stage stays locked until the one before it is done. You research the market before you write the Charter; you approve the Charter before the bot builds the plan; you approve the plan before you assign tasks. If you change the Setup brief later, downstream stages are flagged as out-of-date so you know to regenerate them.

4 • Setup — every field, and how it shapes the plan

Setup is the one screen you must fill by hand. Everything else the bot generates. Here is every field, what to enter, and how it changes the output.

Field	What to enter	How it shapes the plan
Country	The target country.	Sets the regulatory frame, currency, and cultural context. Non-India countries switch the bot off Indian terminology entirely.
State / region	The specific state/region, or leave national.	Narrows all research and touchpoint data to that geography.
Materials	Tick the container types in scope (Liquor, PET, Cans, MLP).	Hard boundary — the bot plans only for these materials.
Implementation model	End-to-End, RVM-only, or Tech Solutions.	Re-points every stage (operations vs hardware vs software).
Operations status	Greenfield or Brownfield.	Determines whether the strategy is market-creation or share/optimisation.
Business objective	One clear sentence on what success looks like.	Every output is checked against this goal — be specific and measurable.
Timeline & dates	Start month/year and target duration.	Anchors the campaign calendar and phasing.
Constraints	Local realities: weather, budget limits, sensitivities.	The bot must account for these in its recommendations.

When Setup is complete you press **Save & Unlock Roadmap**. This creates the project and unlocks the rest of the flow.

5 • The stages, explained

After Setup, the work is organised into four phases plus the Orchestrator. Here is what each produces and how to use it.

Market Research

The foundation. Grounded on live data, it has five parts (sub-tabs):

- Geography Intel — population, administrative structure, and the real touchpoint universe (retail, liquor outlets, HORECA, MRFs).
- Market Intel — the regulatory and economic opportunity for your materials in this geography.
- Stakeholders — the coalition map: government bodies, producers/brands, trade associations, recyclers and the informal sector, with an alignment read.
- Competitors — who else operates or could, their positioning, and where your moat is (domestic precedents only — never invented).
- Resistance — the risk register: who might push back, and on what front.

Pre-planning — the Campaign Charter

The bot reads your locked research and drafts a Charter: the strategic contract every later stage must obey. It has seven sections — situation, challenge, objectives, audience, the ask, scope, and mandates. It is authored by the AI Director and is read-only: you change it by discussing it with Binny, who proposes edits you approve. This is your strategic sign-off before any tactics are built.

Planning — the campaign build

From the approved Charter, the bot builds the full plan:

- Market-Entry Strategy — tuned to Greenfield vs Brownfield.
- Funnel — Branding Acquisition Engagement.
- Moments — festivals and calendar hooks to time activity around.
- Campaign Calendar + Content Calendar — a dense, dated schedule where each content row is an atomic task ready for assignment.

Orchestrator

The plan's tasks are matched to your team members by skill (auto-assigned, and overridable). From here you export the whole calendar to a formatted spreadsheet.

6 • Working with Binny (your AI copilot)

Binny is the AI assistant docked on the right of every screen (and expandable to full page). It is context-aware — it knows which stage you are viewing and can see the project data.

What Binny can do

- Explain any number, chart or decision on the current screen.
- Answer questions using live web search — and it shows the sources under each reply so you can verify.
- Draft documents — emails, official notifications, representation letters, agreements — from the project data.
- Co-author — propose concrete edits to the Charter, plan or task assignments, which you Apply or Dismiss.
- Speak — optional voice replies, and voice input via the mic.

Chats are shared

Conversations are saved per project and are visible to the whole team — so anyone opening a project sees its history. When no project is open, you are in the persistent General chat (marked with a GENERAL badge).

7 • Project Knowledge — feeding the bot your documents

Project Knowledge lets you upload documents that become reference context for every stage and for Binny. Upload a tender, a regulation, a past report or a briefing note, and the bot reads it and tailors its output to it.

How to use it

- Find Project Knowledge in Setup (full panel) or in Binny (compact) — it is the same shared library per project.
- Click Add file and pick a **PDF, Markdown (.md), text (.txt) or CSV**.
- The document is read and stored with the project; it feeds every generation from then on.

8 • Orchestrator & export

The Orchestrator turns the approved plan into assignable work.

- Every content-calendar task is listed with the skill it needs.
- Auto-assign by skill matches each task to the best-fit team member; you can override anyone via the dropdown.
- Export to Sheets downloads a formatted spreadsheet — a task calendar grouped by campaign (colour-coded by funnel stage), plus campaigns and moments tabs — ready to share or run from.

9 • Admin — access & approvals

The bot uses Google sign-in restricted to Recykal / Retearn accounts. New sign-ins land in a pending state and must be approved by an admin before they can use the tool.

Admins get an Admin item in the sidebar with a dashboard to:

- See everyone with access, their role and status.
- Approve or revoke access with one click, and set roles (member / admin).
- See how many projects each person has created, and a recent-projects list of who created what.

10 • Your first project — a full walkthrough

Follow these steps to go from nothing to a complete, assignable plan. Example: selling RVMs into Poland's top retailers.

1**Sign in**

Open the app and sign in with your Recykal Google account. If you are new, an admin approves you first.

2**Create a project**

From Project History, click + Create New Project.

3**Fill Setup carefully**

Country = Poland. Materials = PET, Cans. Model = RVM-only Provider to Retail. Operations status = Brownfield (Poland's DRS is already live). Objective = "Sell 100 RVMs to Poland's top 5 grocery retailers in 12 months." Add any constraints. Then Save & Unlock.

4**(Optional) Add Knowledge**

Upload any tender or briefing PDF/notes so every stage is tailored to it.

5**Run Market Research**

Open Market Research and generate. Review each sub-tab; correct anything by telling Binny. Lock it when happy.

6**Draft & approve the Charter**

Open Pre-planning. The bot drafts the Charter from your research. Refine it via Binny (Discuss on any section), then approve.

7**Generate the Plan**

Open Planning. The bot produces the market-entry strategy, funnel, moments and calendars. Discuss and refine with Binny.

8**Assign & export**

Open the Orchestrator. Click Auto-assign by skill, adjust owners, then Export to Sheets.

11 • Best practices, tips & troubleshooting

Get the most out of it

- Spend real time on Setup — it is the highest-leverage screen.
- Pick Greenfield vs Brownfield correctly (is there already a working DRS here?).
- Upload a tight, curated Knowledge brief rather than a giant unfocused dump.
- Verify Binny's key facts using the sources it now shows under each reply.
- Lock each stage only when you are happy — downstream stages build on it.
- Refine content by talking to Binny and approving its proposals, rather than expecting perfection on the first generation.

If something looks wrong

Symptom	What to do
A stage shows an "out of date" flag	You changed Setup after generating it. Regenerate that stage to re-sync.
Binny gives an answer that feels stale	Check the sources it cites; ask it to verify the latest status. It searches live, but confirm decision-critical facts.
A PDF won't upload / read	It may be a scanned image (no text). Use a text-based PDF or paste the content as .md/.txt.
A generated plan feels generic	Your Setup objective or constraints were probably too vague. Sharpen them and regenerate.
A teammate can't log in	They may be pending approval. An admin approves them in the Admin dashboard.

12 • Glossary

Brownfield	A market where a DRS (or its groundwork) already exists; strategy focuses on share and optimisation.
Charter	The AI-authored strategic contract (situation, challenge, objectives, audience, ask, scope, mandatories) that planning must obey.
Content Calendar	A dense, dated schedule where each row is an atomic task ready to be assigned.
Deposit	The small refundable amount added to a container's price, returned when the empty is brought back.
DRS	Deposit Return System — a scheme to recover drink containers via a refundable deposit.
Funnel	The marketing progression Branding Acquisition Engagement.
Greenfield	A market with no existing DRS; strategy focuses on creating the market from scratch.
Grounding	Live web search the bot uses to base answers on current, cited sources rather than memory.
HORECA	Hotels, Restaurants and Cafés — a key container touchpoint category.
Implementation model	How you operate: End-to-End (whole scheme), RVM-only (supply machines), or Tech Solutions (software backbone).
MLP	Multi-Layer Plastic packaging.
MRF	Material Recovery Facility — where collected material is sorted and processed.
Orchestrator	The stage that assigns plan tasks to team members and exports the calendar.
PET	Polyethylene terephthalate — the common clear plastic used for drink bottles.
Project Knowledge	Documents you upload that become reference context for every stage and Binny.
Return rate	The share of containers returned — the headline DRS success metric.
RVM	Reverse Vending Machine — accepts an empty container and refunds the deposit.
Touchpoint	A physical location where containers are sold or can be returned (retail, liquor, HORECA).

You're ready. Open the bot, create a project, and let Binny take it from there.